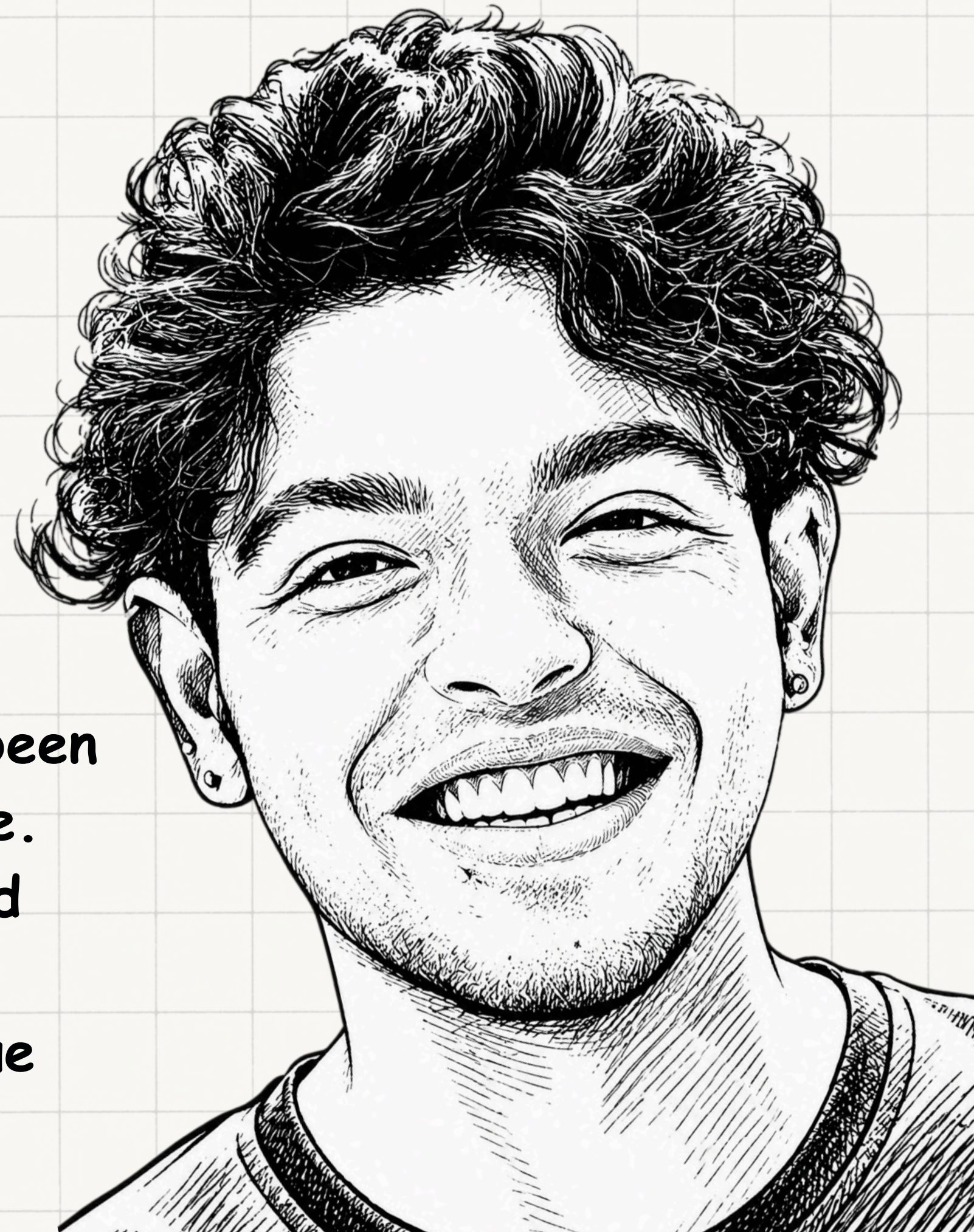


AKASH K R

Akash K R is an artist from Thrissur who has been passionate about drawing from a very young age. He is physically challenged with hearing loss and disabilities affecting both his hands and legs. Despite these challenges, he continued to pursue art with determination and dedication.



ABOUT THE ARTIST & CHALLENGES

His active involvement in art began during his school years, especially from Class 9 onwards. However, financial difficulties limited his access to art materials and proper facilities such as canvas stands, drawing boards, and workspaces. Even when materials were available, he often had to use them carefully for work purposes rather than skill development and experimentation.

Akash explains that accessibility barriers in higher education prevented him from fully experiencing learning opportunities. Due to hearing limitations and the lack of inclusive communication methods, much of the knowledge shared during lectures, faculty programs, and guest sessions became inaccessible to him.

He believes that many artistic and academic opportunities were missed because he could not properly hear or interact with speakers and artists during programs. This also influenced his creative growth, as many of his artistic ideas developed mainly from his own thoughts and experiences rather than broader academic discussions.

Akash draws inspiration from legendary artists such as Vincent van Gogh, Claude Monet, and Paul Cézanne.



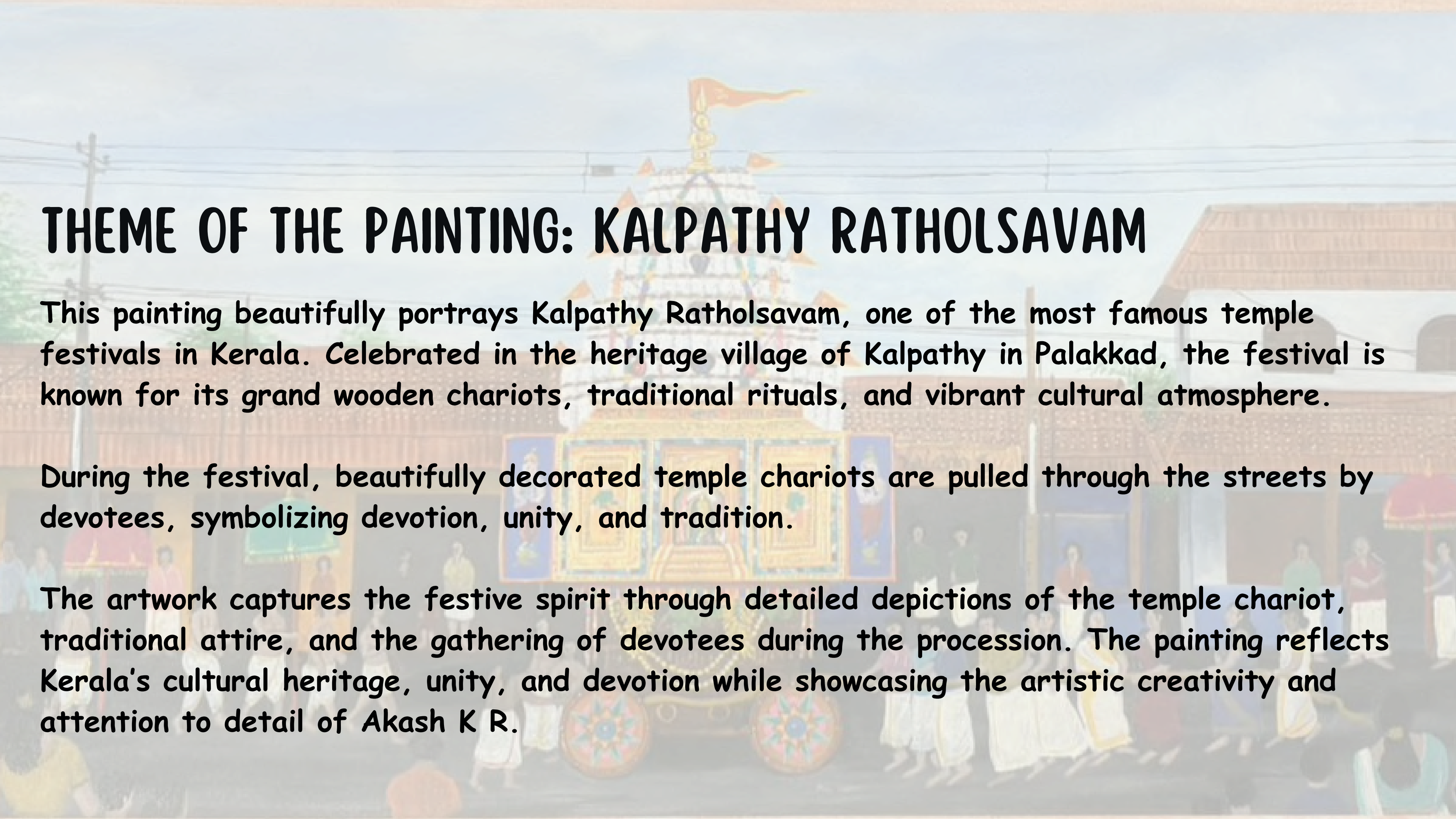
VISION AND MESSAGE

Akash strongly believes that society and institutions should take greater responsibility in creating accessible environments for people with disabilities. He emphasizes that schools, colleges, and public programs must provide proper support systems so that everyone can equally participate and learn.

According to him, technology should be used more effectively to bridge accessibility gaps and improve opportunities for disabled individuals. He compares this idea to the invention of the wheelchair — a tool created by society to support mobility and inclusion.

Akash also mentions that he has developed a project related to physical disabilities and hopes to continue contributing ideas that promote accessibility, inclusion, and equal opportunities for all.





THEME OF THE PAINTING: KALPATHY RATHOLSAVAM

This painting beautifully portrays Kalpathy Ratholsavam, one of the most famous temple festivals in Kerala. Celebrated in the heritage village of Kalpathy in Palakkad, the festival is known for its grand wooden chariots, traditional rituals, and vibrant cultural atmosphere.

During the festival, beautifully decorated temple chariots are pulled through the streets by devotees, symbolizing devotion, unity, and tradition.

The artwork captures the festive spirit through detailed depictions of the temple chariot, traditional attire, and the gathering of devotees during the procession. The painting reflects Kerala's cultural heritage, unity, and devotion while showcasing the artistic creativity and attention to detail of Akash K R.